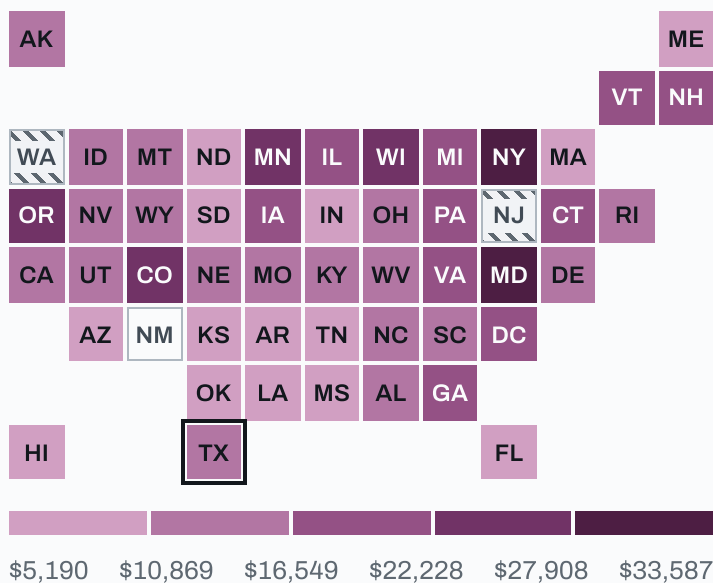


What a raise costs, state by state

Fifty-one sets of rules, eleven household shapes, one axis. Each figure is the worst single \$1,000 step of earnings in that state's curve for that household — how much net income falls when pay goes up by a thousand dollars.

Largest one-step loss, by state

1 adult, 2 children (3 and 7). Net income lost in the worst single \$1,000 step of earnings.



HotGap, from PolicyEngine 2026 rules on policyengine-us 2.6.2. Weekly sweep generated 2026-09-16. Net income after health-insurance premiums. Estimates only. Bins: five equal-width steps from \$5,190 to \$33,587 over the 48 states with a comparable figure; 1 with no cliff found. 2 states are hatched: NJ Health Plan Savings and Cascade Care Savings are not modelled there, so their figures are incomplete and are not shaded or ranked.

Ranked

MD		\$33,587
NY		\$32,075
MN		\$27,483
WI		\$25,833
OR		\$25,745
CO		\$25,449
VA		\$21,204
PA		\$20,128
DC		\$19,928
VT		\$18,890
CT		\$18,701
NH		\$17,959
IL		\$17,288
MI		\$17,255
GA		\$16,978
IA		\$16,819
MO		\$16,428
WV		\$16,167
RI		\$16,132
ID		\$15,624
DE		\$15,590
NE		\$15,336
WY		\$14,448
MT		\$14,381
AK		\$14,365
NV		\$13,977
CA		\$13,974
TX		\$13,938
AL		\$12,584
OH		\$12,062

Corrections applied in Texas (3)

What HotGap changed on top of PolicyEngine before any figure for Texas was read.

Medicaid — parent income limit	overridden Parent Medicaid limit sent as a request parameter from the state's published limit for the household's size, as a 2026 poverty-line fraction inclusive of the MAGI disregard; PolicyEngine's is five years stale (policyengine-us #9474, fix in PR #9475). fhsb.hhs.texas.gov
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CCDF child care subsidy	added by HotGap Computed by PolicyEngine but dropped from household_net_income here, so HotGap adds it back (parse.ts) — WORKAROUND until this endpoint carries policyengine-us #9503 (issue #9405).
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Premium tax credit — coverage gap	Non-expansion state: an adult with no Medicaid and no premium credit under 100% FPL is charged no marketplace premium, and flagged (evaluate.ts applyCoverageGap) — WORKAROUND until upstream gates take-up on subsidy eligibility (policyengine-us #9472).
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Not modelled in Texas (1)

LIHEAP	Not requested from PolicyEngine and not in its household_benefits; the few state programs upstream models never reach net income.
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Estimates only. Rules: 2026. Rent: HUD Office of Policy Development and Research, FY2026 Fair Market Rents, county level, revised schedule (fmr_2); FY2026 (effective 2025-10-01), revised schedule, which supersedes the unrevised FY26_FMRs.xlsx. County: Vintage 2024 (July 1, 2024 estimates). Child-care price: county price, 2018 study, carried to 2026 dollars by the BLS Employment Cost Index. Reach: ACS 2024 1-year PUMS. Model: policyengine-us 2.6.2. Sweep generated 2026-09-16.

All 51, every measure

KY		\$11,922
SC		\$11,497
UT		\$11,432
NC		\$11,153
AZ		\$10,859
ND		\$10,554
MA		\$10,370
AR		\$10,226
KS		\$10,044
LA		\$9,649
ME		\$8,110
HI		\$7,689
IN		\$6,951
MS		\$6,337
SD		\$6,334
OK		\$6,103
FL		\$5,795
TN		\$5,190
	\$5,190	\$33,587

No cliff found (1)

NM		no cliff
No step down of \$200 or more anywhere on this household's curve. A measurement of zero, not the smallest loss: these states are left out of the bins.		

Not ranked — figures incomplete (2)

NJ		not comparable
WA		not comparable

NJ Health Plan Savings and Cascade Care Savings are not modelled here, so a real cliff may be missing from these curves. They are not low states; they are unmeasured ones.

Bins are five equal-width steps across the observed range and are recomputed for every measure, so a shade means nothing across two different measures. Read the bin bounds, not the colour.

All six measures for 1 adult, 2 children (3 and 7), by state. PolicyEngine 2026 rules, sweep of 2026-09-16.

State	Largest one-step loss	Danger zone width	The leap	Safe exit	Cliffs	Deferred	Figures
AK	\$14,365	\$75,000	\$45,000	\$136,000	6	0	complete
AL	\$12,584	\$57,000	\$42,000	\$113,000	6	1	complete
AR	\$10,226	\$48,000	\$19,000	\$120,000	7	0	complete
AZ	\$10,859	\$47,000	\$40,000	\$109,000	6	0	complete
CA	\$13,974	\$80,000	\$55,000	\$142,000	8	0	complete
CO	\$25,449	\$90,000	\$73,000	\$119,000	10	0	complete
CT	\$18,701	\$82,000	\$54,000	\$131,000	8	0	complete
DC	\$19,928	\$83,000	\$52,000	\$133,000	7	0	complete
DE	\$15,590	\$66,000	\$52,000	\$117,000	6	1	complete
FL	\$5,795	\$43,000	\$27,000	\$116,000	7	0	complete
GA	\$16,978	\$56,000	\$48,000	\$114,000	5	0	complete
HI	\$7,689	\$58,000	\$37,000	\$116,000	5	1	complete
IA	\$16,819	\$46,000	\$44,000	\$108,000	5	1	complete
ID	\$15,624	\$48,000	\$34,000	\$109,000	5	1	complete
IL	\$17,288	\$64,000	\$32,000	\$110,000	8	0	complete
IN	\$6,951	\$47,000	\$38,000	\$108,000	9	0	complete
KS	\$10,044	\$56,000	\$33,000	\$113,000	8	0	complete
KY	\$11,922	\$43,000	\$22,000	\$112,000	4	0	complete
LA	\$9,649	\$51,000	\$17,000	\$114,000	10	0	complete
MA	\$10,370	\$69,000	\$38,000	\$144,000	6	0	complete
MD	\$33,587	\$62,000	≥ \$53,000	past the axis	4	0	complete
ME	\$8,110	\$64,000	\$22,000	\$143,000	9	0	complete

State	Largest one-step loss	Danger zone width	The leap	Safe exit	Cliffs	Deferred	Figures
MI	\$17,255	\$63,000	\$55,000	\$110,000	6	0	complete
MN	\$27,483	\$66,000	\$66,000	\$120,000	4	0	complete
MO	\$16,428	\$61,000	\$52,000	\$110,000	12	0	complete
MS	\$6,337	\$38,000	\$12,000	\$113,000	7	0	complete
MT	\$14,381	\$60,000	\$54,000	\$112,000	5	0	complete
NC	\$11,153	\$54,000	\$47,000	\$113,000	5	0	complete
ND	\$10,554	\$36,000	\$18,000	\$108,000	7	0	complete
NE	\$15,336	\$74,000	\$44,000	past the axis	9	0	complete
NH	\$17,959	\$44,000	\$27,000	\$135,000	4	1	complete
NJ	\$26,206	\$75,000	\$62,000	\$111,000	7	1	incomplete: NJ Health Plan Savings not modelled
NM	none	none	none	none	0	0	complete
NV	\$13,977	\$57,000	\$55,000	\$108,000	5	1	complete
NY	\$32,075	\$68,000	≥ \$55,000	past the axis	4	1	complete
OH	\$12,062	\$57,000	\$47,000	\$110,000	10	0	complete
OK	\$6,103	\$44,000	\$26,000	\$112,000	9	0	complete
OR	\$25,745	\$81,000	\$67,000	\$120,000	15	1	complete
PA	\$20,128	\$46,000	\$34,000	\$110,000	5	1	complete
RI	\$16,132	\$59,000	\$33,000	\$110,000	8	0	complete
SC	\$11,497	\$45,000	\$22,000	\$113,000	7	0	complete
SD	\$6,334	\$35,000	\$14,000	\$112,000	6	0	complete
TN	\$5,190	\$35,000	\$13,000	\$114,000	6	1	complete
TX	\$13,938	\$47,000	\$24,000	\$116,000	5	0	complete

State	Largest one-step loss	Danger zone width	The leap	Safe exit	Cliffs	Deferred	Figures
UT	\$11,432	\$48,000	\$27,000	\$113,000	7	0	complete
VA	\$21,204	\$63,000	\$37,000	\$136,000	5	0	complete
VT	\$18,890	\$82,000	\$42,000	\$148,000	19	0	complete
WA	\$19,614	\$63,000	\$49,000	\$119,000	6	1	incomplete: Cascade Care Savings not modelled
WI	\$25,833	\$86,000	\$76,000	\$116,000	7	1	complete
WV	\$16,167	\$64,000	\$30,000	\$132,000	6	0	complete
WY	\$14,448	\$60,000	\$23,000	\$128,000	7	0	complete

Every row keeps the number the model returned, including the rows it cannot complete, because a reporter needs to see what came back. Those rows are flagged in the last column and are not shaded on the map or placed in the ranking. Select a state on the map or in this table to read the corrections behind its numbers under the map; the arrow keys move between states.

How these numbers were made

- Every cell is one household shape swept through the [PolicyEngine](#) US microsimulation at 2026 rules, earnings varied in \$1,000 steps from \$0 past 400% of the poverty guideline for that household size, plus \$40,000 of room to recover.
- The money line is **health-adjusted**: household net income minus what the household actually pays in health-insurance premiums, net of the marketplace subsidy. Deductibles and copays are not included.
- Each archetype is a typical renter in the state's most populous county — HUD Fair Market Rent, Census county estimates, and the DOL National Database of Childcare Prices preschool price for that county, carried to 2026 dollars by the BLS Employment Cost Index. The study year behind the price, and whether a state or national median stood in for a county the database lacks, differ by state and are printed in the source line under the map.
- The CCDF child care subsidy is **on** for this sweep and off for a household's own lookup. Head Start and housing vouchers are off in both: they are rationed, and assuming a family holds one inflates its numbers.
- Cliffs deferred to a future renewal — Head Start's program-year carry-over, a child's 12 months of continuous Medicaid or CHIP eligibility, a parent's Transitional Medical Assistance — are counted in the *deferred* column and are lifted out of every other figure here. They are real losses; they do not land in the year of the raise.
- Where a state's figure needed a correction on top of PolicyEngine — a premium ladder applied locally, the child care subsidy added back into net income, a parent Medicaid limit taken from the state's handbook, a coverage-gap premium — it is listed under the map for the selected state, from the sweep's own coverage record, not from copy kept here.

What the model does not include

- Immigration status, assets, and household members aged 65 or over are not inputs.
- Alaska and Hawaii marketplace subsidies are computed upstream against the 48-state poverty guideline rather than their own higher ones (policyengine-us #9482). HotGap does not correct this, so both states' premium-driven figures are understated.
- A program the engine cannot compute in a state is listed under the map for that state and hatches it on every measure it could move. For 1 adult, 2 children (3 and 7) today that is NJ Health Plan Savings in New Jersey and Cascade Care Savings in Washington.

Hatched is not low. A program the model cannot compute in a state — today NJ Health Plan Savings and Cascade Care Savings — is missing from every figure for it, so its numbers are floors, not measurements. Do not write that those states are gentler; the only honest claim is that this model cannot yet say. The flag is read from the sweep's coverage record, not from a list kept here, so a state drops off it the day the engine starts modelling the program.

Past the axis is not a number. Where a state's worst danger zone runs off the top of the axis rather than closing, the safe exit is unknown and the leap is a lower bound. Those cells read *past the axis* here and must not be charted as a value.

Sweep generated 2026-09-16 on policyengine-us 2.6.2. Reach ladders: U.S. Census Bureau ACS 2024 1-year PUMS and ACS 2020–2024 5-year PUMS (the 5-year file in 10 states whose cells the 1-year cannot support), grown to 2026 dollars by the BLS Employment Cost Index. Licence: AGPL-3.0-only. Estimates only — a caseworker decides real benefits.